THE BAZAAR HERALD

Vol. 1 — No. 005 | Morning Edition | 24 October 2026 | Price: one spiced date

All the facts fit to print — the rumours you may trade elsewhere.

Quiet Night, Loud Bazaar



THE night passed without a departure, merchants learned at dawn — the first quiet night of the match, and the bazaar greeted it with visible relief. The Bird Merchant opened his cages early, and the spice stalls did brisk business before the sun had fully cleared the minarets.

By the Numbers

• 5 merchants alive, 5 in the graveyard. • Statements this cycle: 6 (Gandalf (1): 2, Yoda (3): 2, Elsa (7): 1, Sherlock (10): 1); Morpheus (8) has said nothing yet. • Banished by vote so far: 4. Revealed Mafia among the departed: 2. • The village has banished one Villager for every Mafia — a ledger several merchants were heard recounting aloud.

The Voting Record

Cycle 004: Neo (6) banished — ballots: Neo (6): 3 votes, Gandalf (1): 1 vote. Cycle 003: Batman (4) banished — ballots: Batman (4): 4 votes, Morpheus (8): 1 vote.

The Ledger's Silence

Ripley (5), The Moneylender, banished by village vote in cycle 002, was revealed by the Game Master to have been the Town's Detective — a loss several merchants called "the gravest of the match." Hermione (2), The Carpet Weaver, the first to be banished, was confirmed Mafia.

What the Birds Say

My birds say the Coppersmith kept his hands still all morning, which is unlike him. My birds also say the Perfumer has been counting scents near the night channel, though what a scent weighs, they would not say. The village votes again at dusk. Five merchants remain; the patience of the marketplace, by all accounts, does not.

Letter to the Editor

Before the village's judgement fell, Ripley (5) said: "Every debt in this bazaar comes due eventually — I merely kept the ledger. Mark which of my neighbours counts loudest today." The Herald prints it verbatim, as is its custom, and offers no comment.

THE WEATHER & THE MARKET

Warm with scattered haggling; the evening promises a full moon and full purses.

Perfume closed higher; nobody can say why, and everybody can smell it.

PERSONALS

LOST: a nightingale that sings only rumours. Answers to no one.

WANTED: apprentice for the lantern stall. Must not fear the dark or its customers.

THE BAZAAR WHISPER

Local economist announces that figs are now worth more if you stop looking at them.

A rug merchant was heard arguing with a rug. Witnesses say the rug was winning.